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Submitter Information

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General Comment

Please find comments from the Coalition of Services Industries (CSI) enclosed.

Attachments

CSI Submission on AI Action Plan

Coalition of Services Industries (CSI) Submission:
Comments on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan
to the National Science Foundation and Office of Science and Technology Policy
Docket Number: 2025-02305

AI enables businesses to innovate, improve efficiencies, and create new products and services. The US has been a leader in services and digital trade, and continued leadership in AI helps maintain our competitive edge globally. Whether its driving innovation and productivity across sectors including manufacturing, or streamlining and optimizing logistics and supply chain management, American companies are leveraging AI to be more competitive in international markets. The Coalition of Services Industries (CSI)¹ respectfully submits the following comments for the development of the AI Action Plan.

To ensure America's technology and AI leadership, we must work with our trading partners and international organizations to create and promote best practices, information, and guidance, to ensure that policy and regulatory approaches are interoperable. If the US is not at the table, the rules will be written without us. The Administration should deploy US leadership on AI to convene dialogues and develop frameworks on AI governance, such as with the G7, OECD, and United Nations, to ensure the development of global AI governance aligns with America's values and economic priorities. We encourage the administration to utilize NIST to continue to promote US industry-driven, consensus-based standards and frameworks for AI to address the risk of global regulatory divergence in this space as countries consider their own national and regional AI regulations.

US leadership in AI relies on maintaining the ability of American companies to utilize AI to better serve their customers globally. This requires access to global markets and regulatory environments that allow for AI deployment. We encourage the Administration to work with our trading partners in the following areas:

Risk-Based Approach to Regulations

Promote flexible risk-based approaches rather than overly prescriptive requirements to AI governance. AI is a horizontal technology, applicable to many existing laws and regulations. It is important to examine AI's use and impact in specific applications to evaluate whether existing rules are suitable before developing new technology-specific laws.

Any AI regulations should be specific, targeted, and carefully consider the potential economic and social trade-offs. Policymakers should work closely with industry and other stakeholders to identify high-risk applications of AI and avoid broad categories like entire sectors as high risk, to focus any new rules on the use of technology to address gaps in the application of existing law to high-risk uses of AI, where appropriate. Industry-led, voluntary accountability mechanisms should be utilized to promote innovation and AI deployment across sectors and business uses.

Cross Border Data Flows

¹ CSI, established in 1982, is the leading U.S. industry association devoted exclusively to ensuring America's services businesses, which are increasingly digitally enabled, and workers compete in world markets. CSI member companies represent a broad spectrum of the U.S. services sector including distribution services, express delivery, financial services, media and entertainment, telecommunications, information and communication technology services, and professional services.

Data is foundational to AI. In order to fully realize the benefits of AI, data must be able to flow freely and protected across borders. Policies that restrict data flows or require data to be stored locally limit utilization and access of AI technology, particularly for small businesses. We encourage the Administration to work with trading partners to strengthen their commitments to facilitating cross border data flow and refrain from imposing data localization measures.

Privacy & Cybersecurity

The Administration should work with trading partners to ensure privacy and cybersecurity frameworks are interoperable and do not inhibit AI use and deployment.

Cybersecurity and privacy are foundational to trustworthy AI systems. Because data is so critical to the development of AI, clear and consistent privacy protections for personal privacy are important for building trust in AI and creating the clarity needed for businesses to deploy AI. The Administration should encourage governments to adopt robust but flexible data protection regimes to support data integrity that enables the collection, retention, and processing of data for AI development.

Policymakers should also consider the cybersecurity implications of AI systems and ensure that policies support the use of AI for cybersecurity purposes. Cybersecurity technologies that incorporate AI help organizations keep pace with the evolving threat landscape, including highly sophisticated attackers who constantly improving tactics to evade detection.

International Standards

AI standards are essential to increase interoperability, harmonization, and trust in AI systems. It is imperative that the Administration work with our allies to promote global, voluntary and industry-led standards on AI. Broad adoption of international standards will reduce market access barriers for American businesses and ensure a level playing field globally.

Standards work should also be technology neutral, avoiding preferential treatment for any specific technical approach. ISO and IEC standards (for examples ISO/IEC JTC 1/SC 42 on Artificial Intelligence) provide structured governance and appropriate risk management. It is also important to engage regional standards bodies, for example the European standards organization, CEN and CENELEC, are developing standards as part of implementation for the EU AI Act and will be setting standards that could have much broader influence beyond the EU.

Open Data

Promote AI innovation by pursuing an open data agenda that allows for access to high-value, non-sensitive government data, builds shared computing and data resources that can serve as the infrastructure for open innovation ecosystems, and improves public-private coordination to make it easier to access the computing power necessary to develop and evaluate AI.

Workforce Development

Maintaining US AI leadership will require a workforce with the appropriate skills and training. Collaborating between government, the private sector and academia is vital to ensure a pipeline for developing and acquiring tech talent well-suited for the AI economy. This includes leveraging AI for upskilling and reskilling purposes. These investments will ensure that workers are prepared to responsibly deploy AI tools and adapt to changing workforce needs.